Contractor & Partner Funnel — 22 October

Groundwork by Jalla · prepared for Philip and the team · follows the 21 October status

Where this stands

Philip's walkthrough is built. Onboarding is shorter and no longer asks a mason for an architect's licence; the application is three pages instead of one long form; and nobody can book a call unless they actually qualify for one.

Four faults were found and fixed today. **Two of them were mine**, introduced by yesterday's and today's own changes — both are named below, because how they escaped matters more than that they happened. Migrations 140 to 144 are applied and live.

What Philip asked for, and where it is

Change	State	Note
Specialty replaces the licence page	**Done**	A dropdown of the thirteen trades with an Other box. The long identifiers in the first build were a fault of mine — see overleaf.
Licence only where it is required	**Done**	Asked of architects, structural engineers, quantity surveyors, land surveyors and land lawyers. A mason, carpenter, electrician, plumber, roofer or finisher is never asked.
“How do you trade” removed	**Done**	Gone from onboarding. The application still asks individual or company, which is where that answer is used.
Emergency contacts: three to one	**Done**	One is enough; more can be added from the profile later.
“I’ll do this later” on payment removed	**Done**	You were right that it was broken. Choosing it left the step outstanding, which then blocked the contact screen — the escape hatch trapped people rather than freeing them.
“I don’t have a client” goes to the dashboard	**Done**	Having a client is a condition of applying, so they are no longer sent to a form they cannot qualify on.
Application stops asking the specialty	**Done**	Taken from onboarding. “City you work from” is gone too; regions covered remains.
No call without qualifying	**Done**	Five years or more, a live diaspora project, and a willingness to introduce it. All three, checked before a slot is offered rather than after.
The last page books the call	**Done**	It used to say somebody would write to arrange one, on the very page offering the calendar.
One question at a time	**Done**	Built as three pages of three with a Next, on Favour’s suggestion — nine single-question screens would be a slog for a short application.
Pricing page removed	**Done**	Route, navigation and footer.

Four faults, and how each escaped

1. A mason could not register at all (fixed)

An applicant wrote in: a mason and bricklayer of several years, working independently, with no formal licence and no registered company. The form demanded a professional licence number in three separate places, so there was no way through.

> The data agreed with him. Of the onboarding records on the live system, fourteen of seventeen were independent and none was a registered business — and the mandatory licence box had collected “No”, several strings of keyboard noise, and one Registre du Commerce number, which is a company registration, not a licence. It was not collecting credentials. It was turning away the honest and teaching everyone else to type anything.

2. No client could create a project (fixed)

Every attempt ended with “Groundwork would not save this project to your account”. The insert itself was fine and reading existing projects was fine; what failed was the two together, because the wizard reads the new project back and the rule guarding that read asks a question about a row that does not exist yet.

> The same fault had been found and fixed for contractors months ago, with the rule written down: never re-query the row being inserted. The client case was simply missed — which is why a contractor creating a project for a client worked while a client creating their own did not.

3. Abandoned applications were not being captured (fixed)

Nothing was recorded when somebody started an application and stopped. Yesterday's fix restored the write permissions and was necessary, but not sufficient: the form saves by replacing its own row, and that has to read the row first — which the table deliberately forbids, because those rows hold applicants' names, phone numbers and emails.

> Two correct rules that together made the only operation the form performs impossible. Fixed without opening those rows up to being read. It cost us data: abandoned applications in that window left no trace and cannot be recovered. Capture is working now, and the admin list labels each one Partner or Contractor.

4. “All three emergency contacts are required” (fixed — my error)

Reported from the live form this evening: the screen said one contact was enough, one was filled in, and the button refused it.

> Mine. The change from three to one was written against a function with the wrong name and the wrong field names, so it added something nothing calls and left the live one still demanding three. It passed its test because the test called the function I had just written instead of the one the product uses. There is now a check that every call the app makes resolves to a function that exists, with the fields it actually sends.

A fifth, smaller one: the new specialty dropdown shipped showing its own internal labels rather than trade names. Also mine, from a one-word mistake in a lookup path. Nothing threw and no test failed — a missing label quietly renders as its own name — so it was visible only by looking at the screen. There is now a test that every trade resolves to a readable name in both languages.

Decisions taken today

Question	Decision
Which trades need a licence?	The regulated professions only — architect, structural engineer, quantity surveyor, land surveyor, land lawyer. Everyone else is never asked.
Where does “five years” fall?	Three-to-five does **not** qualify. Only five-to-ten and ten-plus can book, since somebody in the lower band may have three.
One question per screen?	Three pages of three, with a Next. Nine screens would be a slog; one long form is what people abandoned.

Open, and who it needs

Item	Owner	Note
Vanessa is on **every** call, not only French ones	Philip	A Google co-host sits on the schedule, not on a booking, so she is now invited to English calls too. “Vanessa for French speakers” cannot be expressed that way. Worth knowing before it surprises anyone.
Vanessa’s address for French applicants	Favour — needs the address	One line of configuration. Until it is set, nothing tells her a French applicant has come in.
“Join as a contractor” on the home page	Team decision	Proposed for removal as duplicating “Join for Free”. Reasonable — the home page is a client page and contractors arrive from outreach. Only condition: outreach must link straight to the contractor sign-up, not to the home page.
Civil Engineer in the trade list	Team decision	The list has Structural Engineer. Adding or renaming is a change to the shared list behind the public application.
Four further end-to-end runs	Favour	Client invitation is verified working in production. Free-tier project creation was broken and is now fixed; it needs one clean run to confirm.

3,109 automated checks pass and the build is clean. Migrations 140–144 are applied. The funnel figures are not worth quoting yet — the accounts and applications on the system are mostly from today’s testing, and will stay meaningless until real outreach runs.